



Guest Column R. ZUTSHI

Changing Face of Display

Varying contours of the Indian market heralds the age of LCD and plasma televisions



Slim displays are all set to dominate the market—both in India and abroad. The television market is in the midst of a dramatic transi-

tion. The most obvious transformation is the change in the demand for the forms of television—slim is in. But going beyond that, the performance parameters too are undergoing a revolution as is the functionality linked with growing connectivity.

Today, one of the most dramatic changes sweeping across the colour television market is the exponential growth of the flat panel television (FPTV) market, in common parlance called the liquid crystal display (LCD) and plasma televisions. As per research data available, the global market for FPTV is expected to grow from 51 million units in 2006 to 127 million by 2009.

Another noticeable trend in displays, which strikes you the minute you enter the Consumer Electronics Show or the IFA Show, is that more and more full high definition (HD) or 1080p products are being introduced in the market. Just as you have the LCD and Plasma televisions that give you an enhanced viewing experience at the highest resolution, you have the DVD players, home theatre systems that play full HD content and even camcorders that allow you to record and play content with 1080p resolution. Thus, we see full HD LCD televisions (with 1080p resolution) coming into the market with high-definition multimedia interface connections for connecting HD

digital devices like disc players, game consoles as well as cameras, camcorders and laptops.

In India too, the FPTV is witnessing an exponential growth. Its market, which was a mere 1.5 lakh units last year, is expected to grow to 4 lakh units this year. Over the last couple of years, the LCD prices in the country have dropped by around 30 per cent annually. Some of the other factors that have fuelled this growth include the increasing awareness of the benefits of LCD televisions, the growing availability of the product across dealer counters, the

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upgradation that is happening from the 29-inch flat segment and of course, the availability of finance schemes in the market. We expect the FPTV market to grow to 3 million units by 2009.

The 32-inch and 40-inch LCD television segment is rapidly gaining popularity in the market here and it is believed that this trend will get more predominant over the next few years. The Indian market, even as it is showing trends similar to that of the global markets in the FPTV category, still has a unique character when it comes to the Flat televi-

sion category. The country's market is witnessing a very healthy growth in the flat TV Market, which today constitutes around 70 per cent of the total colour television market in India. I expect it to continue its domination over the next few years, with higher growth in semi-urban markets. The urban markets are expected to show a higher adoption of LCD televisions.

The flat TV market has shown a growth of over 45 per cent in the year so far. This year, the slim and ultra slim TV market is expected to be sell around 4,00,000 units in India. In the flat TV segment, the 21-inch screen size dominates, with the 29-inch screen size segment constituting around 10 per cent. Here again, the popularity of the larger screen sizes is on a rise. The conventional curved TV (CRT) market, of course, continues to show a rapid growth.

Thus, the Indian market is witnessing some very exciting times at the moment, across all the segments. On one hand, you have the advent of light-emitting diode technology, the latest in the world of LCDs, and full HD LCD televisions at the higher end of the spectrum. On the other hand, you have manufacturers making innovations in the flat TV segment to help fuel the growth of the overall CRT segment in India, especially in the semi-urban markets. There is action in all segments of the Indian market, but nobody is complaining. Certainly, not the consumer!

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